Alcaraz's comeback win sends Jodar to the ATP Finals

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Carlos Alcaraz saved two match points and fought back to beat Taylor Fritz 6-7 (10-12), 7-5, 6-3 on Friday, November 6. The win did more than send Alcaraz into the semi-finals. It also booked a place at the season-ending ATP Finals for 20-year-old Spaniard Jodar. Fritz edged a tight first set, winning the **tie-break** after both players had chances to take it. Then he moved a break ahead in the second set, and the match looked like it was slipping away from Alcaraz. But the 23-year-old Spaniard refused to fold. He saved two match points, broke Fritz twice, and levelled the match. From there, he took charge. Alcaraz moved 3-1 ahead in the **decider** and closed out the contest with a powerful **forehand**. 'I tried not to let myself down in those difficult moments to stay strong mentally,' Alcaraz said.

Alcaraz will face either Casper Ruud or Nuno Borges in the semi-finals. Jodar's place at the finals in Turin, Italy, is now secure. The event, held at Turin's Inalpi Arena from November 15 to 22, features the top eight men's singles players in the world. Jodar will make his **debut** there, as will American Frances Tiafoe, 28. Tiafoe's spot was confirmed earlier, when Tommy Paul lost 6-4, 4-6, 6-3 to fellow American Ben Shelton. The eight qualifiers are Alexander Zverev, Daniil Medvedev, Flavio Cobolli, Arthur Fils, Alcaraz, Shelton, Tiafoe and Jodar.

Jodar only became a full-time professional at the beginning of 2026, but his **debut** season has drawn major attention. The Madrid-born youngster won three ATP **Challenger** titles in 2025 and claimed his first ATP Tour title in Marrakech in April 2026. Tiafoe, nicknamed 'Big Foe', is a three-time ATP Tour title winner known for his energetic style and passionate celebrations. He reached the US Open semi-finals in 2022 and 2024.

Word Treasure

tie-break -- A short extra part of a set played when the score is tied, to decide who wins the set.

decider -- The final set of a match, played when each player has won one set.

Challenger -- A lower-level professional tennis tournament where players earn points to climb the rankings.

debut -- A person's first appearance in an event or competition.

forehand -- A tennis shot hit with the front of the racket, on the same side as the player's racket hand.

Background you need

In tennis, a match is won by taking the most sets, and a player who faces match point is one point away from losing.

The ATP Finals is a season-ending tournament for the top men's singles players, so reaching it is a big prize for the season's best performers.

A strong season can earn a player a place there even before the last matches are played, which is what happened for a young player after another player's comeback win.

Jodar's rise is striking because he only recently turned full-time professional, yet he has already won titles and climbed into the world's top group.

Break it down

LEAD: Alcaraz saved two match points to beat Fritz and reach the semi-finals, and the win also sent Jodar to the ATP Finals.

KEY EVENT: Alcaraz came back from a set down and a break down to win 6-7 (10-12), 7-5, 6-3.

+- WHO: Carlos Alcaraz and Taylor Fritz

+- WHEN: Friday, November 6

+- HOW: Alcaraz saved two match points, broke Fritz twice, and closed out the decider with a powerful forehand

EVIDENCE: Alcaraz said he tried to stay strong mentally in the difficult moments.

WHAT IT MEANS: Jodar's place at the finals in Turin is secure, and Tiafoe will also make his debut there.

Why it matters

The ATP Finals gathers the season's top men's singles players, so qualifying marks a player as one of the year's best, and for Jodar it caps a first full-time season that has already brought titles and major attention.

Test what you remember

1. Who did Carlos Alcaraz beat in his comeback win?

- (A) Nuno Borges
- (B) Taylor Fritz
- (C) Ben Shelton
- (D) Casper Ruud

2. What was the score of Alcaraz's win over Fritz?

- (A) 6-3, 6-3, 6-3
- (B) 6-4, 4-6, 6-3
- (C) 7-5, 6-3, 6-7
- (D) 6-7 (10-12), 7-5, 6-3

3. How many match points did Alcaraz save against Fritz?

- (A) Two
- (B) Three
- (C) One
- (D) None

4. Where are the ATP Finals held?

- (A) Turin, Italy
- (B) London
- (C) Madrid, Spain
- (D) Marrakech

5. Who else will make his debut at the ATP Finals alongside Jodar?

- (A) Frances Tiafoe
- (B) Ben Shelton
- (C) Alexander Zverev
- (D) Tommy Paul

6. How many ATP Challenger titles did Jodar win in 2025?

- (A) Three
- (B) Two
- (C) One
- (D) Five

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: D 3: A 4: A 5: A 6: A

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):